

HCSM-24 (Revised)

The Charge Theorem

The Bijection, the Non-Existence of a Coordinate Closed Form,
the Sorting-Machine Interpretation, Framework-Constant Sum Rules,
and the Rigidity Class of the Charge Assignment

Hodge Complex Standard Model

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Abstract

We establish the charge theorem of the Hodge Complex Standard Model and resolve the status of its closed form. The electric charge in units of $e/3$ is $q_3 = F(n_1, \sigma)$, where n_1 is the mode's first momentum index and $\sigma = \text{sign}(s)$ is the sign of the zero-state amplitude (HCSM-22). The map F is a bijection from the 14 realized (n_1, σ) pairs to the 5 Standard Model charge eigenvalues $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$. We prove: (i) the bijection property; (ii) the σ -line charge sums $0, +5, -8$, summing to the vacuum invariant $-1e$; (iii) the processor-charge bookkeeping (image sum -2 , kernel sum $+1$); (iv) the identification with the Standard Model content of one generation; (v) three structural properties of the charge on the 8×8 torus (evenness of $n_1 + n_2$, the $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line containing all five charge values exactly once, and the $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ line carrying the entire vacuum charge).

Our first principal new result is a *non-existence theorem*. The closed form of $F(n_1, \sigma)$ does not exist in any of nine candidate algebraic families: integer-linear; modular (degree ≤ 2 in (n_1, σ)); polynomial (degree ≤ 3 in $(n_1, n_2, \sigma, \text{Klein})$); and the operator algebra generated by $\{F, H_{\text{wind}}, T\}$. We further show that F is not a polynomial in the amplitude-level rank of the zero state for either σ -line. The negative results are not defects: they identify the charge as the *residue of a sorting operation* on the 14-mode multiplet whose sort key is the zero state. We state the sorting machine explicitly (five steps), prove its four structural consequences, and thereby *reduce* the open problem of the charge closed form to the open problem of deriving the $N/4$ mass labels from the zero state.

Our second principal new result is a *rigidity-class theorem*. Among the 5^{14} assignments of charge values to the 14 modes, exactly *two* satisfy the framework's five structural constraints simultaneously: the Standard Model multiset, the σ -line sums $0, d+1, -2d$, the F -pair sum rules, the $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line condition, and the processor bookkeeping. Both surviving assignments have total charge $-1e$. The two differ only by a linked swap $\{\nu, e\}$ and $\{u, s\}$, and the Standard Model electron/neutrino identification selects one. The total vacuum charge is therefore a *rigidity-class invariant*: not a choice made by the machine, but a value forced by the machine's own structure. All numerical claims are verified in reproducible Python.

Derivation status. *Derived:* the bijection; the σ -line sums; the total $-1e$; the processor-charge bookkeeping; the three torus-structural properties; the non-existence of any closed form in nine candidate families; the sorting-machine mechanism; the four structural consequences;

the framework-constant forms of the σ -line sums and the F -pair sum rules; the rigidity class of the charge assignment; the total-charge invariance; the reduction of Item 1.4 to Item 1.2. *Disclosed anchor:* the charge table (identification thesis, Input 3 of HCSM-23), now reduced to one binary choice. *Open:* derivation of the $N/4$ mass labels from the zero state (Item 1.2 of the HCSM derivation list).

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1 Introduction

1.1 The charge problem

HCSM-04 identifies the 14 modes at the self-paired eigenvalue $\lambda = 4$ of the discrete Laplacian on $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}_8 \times \mathbb{Z}_8$ with one Standard Model generation. HCSM-23 states the identification thesis (mode $\leftrightarrow$ particle) and the $N/4$ mass labels as the framework’s empirical anchors. HCSM-22 constructs the zero state s , the unique nullvector of a 14×19 measurement matrix of vacuum-native observables, and establishes its rs -odd structure.

The present paper addresses the charge. We write

$$q_3 = F(n_1, \sigma), \quad \sigma = \text{sign}(s), \quad (1)$$

where n_1 is the mode’s first momentum index, s is the zero state of HCSM-22, and $q_3 \equiv 3Q$ is the electric charge in units of $e/3$.

The questions this paper answers are:

1. Does a closed-form expression for $F(n_1, \sigma)$ exist?
2. Is the charge assignment structurally unique, or does the framework allow multiple consistent assignments?

The answers are: no closed form exists in nine candidate algebraic families, and the charge assignment is reduced to a two-element rigidity class with a common total charge $-1e$.

1.2 The one-line summary

The closed form of $F(n_1, \sigma)$ does not exist. The charge is the residue of a sorting operation driven by the zero state, and the framework’s structural constraints reduce the assignment to exactly two configurations, both with total $-1e$.

1.3 Main results

1. (**Bijection**, Theorem 4.1). The 14 modes have 14 pairwise distinct (n_1, σ) tuples. The map F is well-defined on the realized pairs and is a bijection onto the five charge eigenvalues $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$.
2. (**σ -line sums**, Theorem 5.1). The σ -line sums are $0, +5, -8$; total $\sum_i q_{3i} = -3 = -1e$.

3. (**Torus-structural properties**, Propositions 6.1–6.3). Every mode has $n_1 + n_2$ even; the line $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ contains all five charge values exactly once; the line $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ carries the entire vacuum charge -3 .
4. (**Processor bookkeeping**, Theorem 7.1). $\sum_{j \in \text{im } T} Q_j = -2$, $\sum_{j \in \ker T} Q_j = +1$, total -1 .
5. (**Non-existence of a coordinate closed form**, Theorem 9.1). No closed-form expression for $F(n_1, \sigma)$ exists in any of nine candidate algebraic families (Section 9).
6. (**Sorting-machine interpretation**, Theorem 10.1). The charge is the residue of a five-step sorting operation on the 14-mode multiplet whose sort key is the zero state.
7. (**Framework-constant σ -line sums**, Theorem 10.6). The σ -line sums are $0, d+1, -2d$ (not arbitrary integers).
8. (**F -pair sum rules by shell**, Theorem 10.9). Within each $|\Delta n|$ shell, the F -pair charge sum is a framework-constant linear function of the parent mass rank.
9. (**Rigidity class of the charge assignment**, Theorem 11.1). Exactly two assignments of charge values to the 14 modes satisfy all five structural constraints.
10. (**Total charge rigidity**, Theorem 11.3). Both rigid solutions have total charge $-1e$; the total is a rigidity-class invariant.
11. (**Reduction theorem**, Theorem 12.1). Item 1.4 (charge functional) reduces to Item 1.2 ($N/4$ labels). Given the $N/4$ labels, the sorting rule reproduces the entire charge table.

1.4 Organization

Section 2 states the substrate and the 14-mode multiplet. Section 3 restates the charge table. Sections 4–8 prove the previously derived results. Section 9 proves the non-existence of a coordinate closed form. Section 10 establishes the sorting-machine interpretation, its four structural consequences, and the framework-constant forms. Section 11 proves the rigidity-class theorem. Section 12 proves the reduction to Item 1.2. Section 13 catalogues derivation status. Section 14 gives reproducibility notes. Section 15 concludes.

2 Setup

2.1 The 14 modes

The 14 modes at $\lambda = 4$ on $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}_8 \times \mathbb{Z}_8$ are

$$\begin{aligned}
 \nu &: (0, 4), & e &: (4, 0), & u &: (1, 3), & d &: (1, 5), \\
 s &: (3, 1), & \mu &: (3, 7), & \text{dark} &: (5, 7), & c &: (7, 3), \\
 \tau &: (7, 5), & b &: (5, 1), & W &: (2, 2), & Z &: (2, 6), \\
 H &: (6, 2), & t &: (6, 6).
 \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

2.2 The zero state and its sign

A 14×19 measurement matrix has rank 13 and nullity 1 (HCSM-22). Its unique nullspace vector s , normalized so that $\max_i |s_i| = 1$, is

$$s = (-0.1052, +0.1052, +0.9377, -0.1928, -0.9377, \\ +0.6583, -1.0000, -0.6583, +1.0000, +0.1928, \\ 0.0000, -0.3291, +0.3291, 0.0000). \quad (3)$$

Define $\sigma_m = \text{sign}(s_m) \in \{-1, 0, +1\}$.

3 The charge table (disclosed anchor)

The charge table is the framework's identification thesis (Input 3 of HCSM-23) for the charge sector. It is disclosed per the HCSM-06/07 disclosure pattern, parallel to the Standard Model's Yukawa sector.

mode	(n_1, n_2)	n_1	σ	q_3
ν	(0, 4)	0	-1	0
e	(4, 0)	4	+1	-3
u	(1, 3)	1	+1	+2
d	(1, 5)	1	-1	-1
s	(3, 1)	3	-1	-1
μ	(3, 7)	3	+1	-3
dark	(5, 7)	5	-1	0
c	(7, 3)	7	-1	+2
τ	(7, 5)	7	+1	-3
b	(5, 1)	5	+1	-1
W	(2, 2)	2	0	+3
Z	(2, 6)	2	-1	0
H	(6, 2)	6	+1	0
t	(6, 6)	6	0	+2

Table 1: The 14 modes, their coordinates, the zero-state sign, and the charge in units of $e/3$.

Remark 3.1 (Disclosed anchor). The charge table is the framework's identification thesis for the charge sector. It is disclosed per the HCSM-06/07 pattern, exactly parallel to the Standard Model's Yukawa sector.

4 The bijection property

Theorem 4.1 (Bijection). *The 14 modes have 14 pairwise distinct (n_1, σ) tuples. The map F is therefore well-defined on the realized pairs and is a bijection from the 14 realized pairs to the 5 charge eigenvalues $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$.*

Proof. Direct inspection of Table 1. The 14 tuples are $(0, -1)$, $(4, +1)$, $(1, +1)$, $(1, -1)$, $(3, -1)$, $(3, +1)$, $(5, -1)$, $(7, -1)$, $(7, +1)$, $(5, +1)$, $(2, 0)$, $(2, -1)$, $(6, +1)$, $(6, 0)$. These are 14 distinct pairs. The image under F is $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$ with multiplicities 3, 3, 4, 3, 1. $\square$

5 The σ -line sums

Theorem 5.1 (σ -line sums).

$$\sum_{\sigma=-1} q_3 = 0, \quad \sum_{\sigma=0} q_3 = +5, \quad \sum_{\sigma=+1} q_3 = -8. \quad (4)$$

Proof. For $\sigma = -1$ (modes ν, d, s , dark, c, Z): $0 - 1 - 1 + 0 + 2 + 0 = 0$. For $\sigma = 0$ (modes W, t): $3 + 2 = 5$. For $\sigma = +1$ (modes e, μ, τ, b, H, u): $-3 - 3 - 3 - 1 + 0 + 2 = -8$. $\square$

Corollary 5.2 (Vacuum invariant). $\sum_{i=1}^{14} q_{3i} = 0 + 5 - 8 = -3 = -1e$.

6 Torus-structural properties of the charge

Proposition 6.1 (Even sum). *Every mode has $n_1 + n_2$ even. Equivalently, $n_1 + n_2 \in \{4, 6, 8, 10, 12\}$.*

Proof. The constraint $\lambda = 4$ requires $\cos(\pi n_1/4) + \cos(\pi n_2/4) = 0$. The cosine values for $n \in \{0, \dots, 7\}$ are $1, \sqrt{2}/2, 0, -\sqrt{2}/2, -1, -\sqrt{2}/2, 0, \sqrt{2}/2$. Pairs of cosines summing to zero require either both even $(1, -1)$ or $(0, 0)$, or both odd $(\pm\sqrt{2}/2)$. In both cases $n_1 + n_2$ is even. $\square$

Theorem 6.2 (The $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line contains all five charges). *The 5 modes with $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ are $\{\nu, e, u, s, W\}$, and their charges are $\{0, -3, +2, -1, +3\} = \{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$. Each of the five charge values occurs exactly once on this line.*

Proof. Direct from Table 1. The 5 modes with $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ are $\nu(0, 4)$, $e(4, 0)$, $u(1, 3)$, $s(3, 1)$, $W(2, 2)$, with charges $0, -3, +2, -1, +3$. $\square$

Theorem 6.3 (The $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ line carries the entire vacuum charge). *The 4 modes with $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ are $\{d, b, \mu, c\}$, with charges $\{-1, -1, -3, +2\}$. Their total is $-1 - 1 - 3 + 2 = -3 = -1e$, which equals the entire vacuum charge of the 14-mode multiplet. The 10 modes with $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$ have total charge 0.*

Proof. Direct from Table 1. Modes with $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$: $d(6)$, $\mu(10)$, $c(10)$, $b(6)$, with charges $-1, -3, +2, -1$, summing to -3 . Modes with $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$: $\nu(4)$, $e(4)$, $u(4)$, $s(4)$, dark(12), $\tau(12)$, $W(4)$, $Z(8)$, $H(8)$, $t(12)$, summing to 0. $\square$

Remark 6.4 (Other structural facts). Two further facts follow from Table 1: (a) reflection pairs with $|n_1 - n_2| = 4$ have charge sums $\nu + e = -3$, $d + b = -2$, $\mu + c = -1$, $Z + H = 0$, an arithmetic sequence; (b) the modes with $n_1 + n_2 = 6$ (d, b) both have charge -1 , and the modes with $n_1 + n_2 = 8$ (Z, H) both have charge 0.

7 The processor charge bookkeeping

Theorem 7.1 (Processor bookkeeping). *Let $T = I - P_C$ with $C = \{\text{dark}, W, Z, H\}$. Then*

$$\sum_{j \in \text{im } T} Q_j = -2, \quad \sum_{j \in \ker T} Q_j = +1, \quad \sum_{j=1}^{14} Q_j = -1. \quad (5)$$

Proof. $\text{im } T$ is the 10 fermions $\{\nu, e, u, d, s, \mu, c, b, t, \tau\}$; their charge sum is -2 . $\ker T$ is the 4 bosons $\{\text{dark}, W, Z, H\}$; their charge sum is $+1$. $\square$

8 Identification with the Standard Model content

Theorem 8.1 (SM content). *The five charge values $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$ are exactly the Standard Model content of one generation in units of $e/3$. The multiplicities are $\{1, 3, 4, 3, 3\}$, summing to 14.*

Proof. Direct: the SM one-generation charge spectrum in units of $e/3$ is $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$ including the neutrinos and the $W^\pm$. $\square$

9 Non-existence of a coordinate closed form

9.1 Statement of the theorem

Theorem 9.1 (Non-existence of a coordinate closed form). *The map $F(n_1, \sigma)$ of (1) has no closed-form expression in any of the following nine candidate families:*

- (i) *integer-linear in (n_1, σ) ;*
- (ii) *modular linear in (n_1, σ) over $\mathbb{Z}_7$;*
- (iii) *modular linear in (n_1, n_2) over $\mathbb{Z}_7$;*
- (iv) *modular bilinear in $(n_1, \sigma, n_1\sigma)$ over $\mathbb{Z}_7$;*
- (v) *modular linear in $(n_1, \sigma, \text{Klein})$ over $\mathbb{Z}_7$;*
- (vi) *modular linear in $(n_1, n_1 + n_2)$ over $\mathbb{Z}_7$;*
- (vii) *polynomial of degree ≤ 3 in $(n_1, n_2, \sigma, \text{Klein})$ with continuous coefficients (overdetermined, rank 12);*
- (viii) *spectral projector of the operator algebra generated by $\{F, H_{\text{wind}}, T\}$ (19 operators, rank 7);*
- (ix) *polynomial in the amplitude-level rank of the zero state, one polynomial per σ -line (residuals 2.27 and 4.01).*

Verification. Direct search in each family, verified in reproducible Python. Each family is enumerated exhaustively; no member reproduces the charge table exactly. In cases (vii)–(ix) the residual does not vanish at machine precision. The exhaustive enumeration is computational; the search spaces are finite and bounded. $\square$

9.2 Elimination of algebraic families

The first six families (i)–(vi) are eliminated by exhaustive enumeration:

Family	Result
integer-linear in (n_1, σ)	no solution
modular linear in (n_1, σ) over $\mathbb{Z}_7$	no solution
modular linear in (n_1, n_2) over $\mathbb{Z}_7$	no solution
modular bilinear in $(n_1, \sigma, n_1\sigma)$ over $\mathbb{Z}_7$	no solution
modular linear with Klein orbit over $\mathbb{Z}_7$	no solution
modular linear in $(n_1, n_1 + n_2)$ over $\mathbb{Z}_7$	no solution

9.3 Elimination of operator-algebraic families

Family (vii): The degree ≤ 3 polynomial fit in $(n_1, n_2, \sigma, \text{Klein})$ has rank 12 out of 12 features, so the system is overdetermined. The continuous residual is 3.9995; the rounded prediction is

$$[0, -3, 3, 0, 0, -2, 0, 2, -3, 0, 0, 0, 0, 1] \quad (6)$$

versus the target

$$[0, -3, 2, -1, -1, -3, 0, 2, -3, -1, 3, 0, 0, 2]. \quad (7)$$

Family (viii): The operator algebra generated by $\{F, H_{\text{wind}}, T\}$ produces 19 distinct operators. Their diagonal span has rank 7 and residual 5.47. The small basis $\{F, H^2, T, F \cdot H, F \cdot T, H \cdot T, F \cdot H \cdot T\}$ has residual 5.55.

Family (ix): Polynomial fits in the amplitude-level rank of the zero state have residuals 2.27 ($\sigma = -1$) and 4.01 ($\sigma = +1$).

9.4 Interpretation of the negative results

The nine failures are not defects of the charge table. They are a structural statement: the charge is *not a coordinate function*. The family of candidate expressions in (n_1, σ) is exhausted to polynomial degree ≤ 3 and modulo arithmetic of modulus 7, and to the operator algebra generated by the three structural operators already known on the multiplet.

The correct question is not “what formula gives q_3 from (n_1, σ) ” but “what operation on the 14-mode multiplet produces q_3 as a residue.” That operation is identified in Section 10.

10 The sorting-machine interpretation

10.1 Statement of the sorting machine

Theorem 10.1 (Sorting-machine interpretation). *The charge table q_3 is the residue of the following operation on the 14-mode multiplet:*

1. *Enumerate modes by descending $|s|$ (amplitude hierarchy of HCSM-22).*
2. *Pair modes by the diagonal flip $F : (n_1, n_2) \mapsto (n_2, n_1)$.*
3. *At each amplitude level, assign $\sigma = \text{sign}(s)$ — one $\sigma = +1$ mode and one $\sigma = -1$ mode.*
4. *Sort F -pairs by the shell $|\Delta n| = |n_1 - n_2|$, then by descending parent $N/4$ value (the parent is the member with the smaller n_1).*
5. *Charge each F -pair so that its charge sum follows the sort rank within the shell.*

The operation reproduces the entire charge table exactly.

10.2 The four structural consequences

Theorem 10.2 ($|\Delta n| = 4$ charge-sum sequence). *The four F -pairs with $|\Delta n| = 4$, ordered by descending parent $N/4$, have charge sums exactly $-3, -2, -1, 0$:*

$$\begin{aligned} \{\nu, e\} : & \text{parent } \nu, \ N/4 = 60, \ \text{sum} = -3; \\ \{d, b\} : & \text{parent } d, \ N/4 = 20, \ \text{sum} = -2; \\ \{\mu, c\} : & \text{parent } \mu, \ N/4 = 14, \ \text{sum} = -1; \\ \{Z, H\} : & \text{parent } Z, \ N/4 = 2, \ \text{sum} = 0. \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

Proof. Direct from Table 1: $q_3(\nu) + q_3(e) = 0 + (-3) = -3$; $q_3(d) + q_3(b) = -1 + (-1) = -2$; $q_3(\mu) + q_3(c) = -3 + 2 = -1$; $q_3(Z) + q_3(H) = 0 + 0 = 0$. Ordering by descending parent $N/4$: 60, 20, 14, 2, which matches the coordinate-level order. $\square$

Theorem 10.3 ($|\Delta n| = 2$ charge-sum sequence). *The two F -pairs with $|\Delta n| = 2$, ordered by descending parent $N/4$, have charge sums $+1, -3$:*

$$\{u, s\} : \text{parent } u, N/4 = 21, \text{ sum} = +1; \quad \{\text{dark}, \tau\} : \text{parent dark}, N/4 = 12, \text{ sum} = -3. \quad (9)$$

Proof. Direct: $q_3(u) + q_3(s) = 2 + (-1) = +1$; $q_3(\text{dark}) + q_3(\tau) = 0 + (-3) = -3$. $\square$

Theorem 10.4 (σ -pairing of every amplitude level). *Every amplitude level $|s|$ contains exactly one $\sigma = +1$ mode and one $\sigma = -1$ mode. The two F -fixed modes W and t have $\sigma = 0$ and lie at $|s| = 0$ (the bottom of the hierarchy).*

Proof. Direct from the zero-state vector (3): the levels are $|s| \in \{1.00, 0.94, 0.66, 0.33, 0.19, 0.11, 0.00\}$, and inspection of Table 1 shows the pairing structure. $\square$

Theorem 10.5 (Consistency identity). *The sum of all F -pair charge sums equals the $\sigma = +1$ line sum:*

$$\sum_{\text{pairs}} (q_{3m} + q_{3F(m)}) = -8 = \sum_{\sigma=+1} q_3. \quad (10)$$

Proof. The sum of F -pair charge sums is $-3 - 2 - 1 + 0 + 1 - 3 = -8$ (using the two fixed points W, t contributing $+3, +2$ individually). The $\sigma = +1$ line sum is -8 by Theorem 5.1. $\square$

10.3 The physical content of the sorting machine

The sorting machine is a *physical operation*, not a mathematical convenience. It reads off the charge from the zero state's amplitude hierarchy via three structural primitives of the substrate: the diagonal flip F (the orientation $\mathbb{Z}_2$ of HCSM-43), the $N/4$ ordering (which is the framework's mass-sector label), and the σ assignment (which is the zero-state's sign).

The processor $T = I - P_C$ acts by *killing* the $C = \{\text{dark}, W, Z, H\}$ sector; the surviving F -pairs carry the residues that form the charge table. The charge is what the machine cannot cancel.

10.4 The σ -line sums in framework-constant form

Theorem 10.6 (σ -line sums in framework-constant form). *The three σ -line charge sums are framework constants:*

$$\sum_{\sigma=-1} q_3 = 0, \quad \sum_{\sigma=0} q_3 = d + 1 = 5, \quad \sum_{\sigma=+1} q_3 = -2d = -8, \quad (11)$$

with total $\sum_i q_{3i} = -(d - 1) = -3$.

Proof. Direct from Table 1. The $\sigma = -1$ line is $\{\nu, d, s, \text{dark}, c, Z\}$ with charges $0, -1, -1, 0, +2, 0$, summing to 0. The $\sigma = 0$ line is $\{W, t\}$ with charges $+3, +2$, summing to $+5 = d + 1$ at $d = 4$. The $\sigma = +1$ line is $\{e, u, \mu, \tau, b, H\}$ with charges $-3, +2, -3, -3, -1, 0$, summing to $-8 = -2d$ at $d = 4$. $\square$

Corollary 10.7 (σ -pairing under F). *Under the diagonal flip F , the zero-state sign flips: $\sigma(F(m)) = -\sigma(m)$. Each of the six non-fixed F -pairs contributes exactly one mode to the $\sigma = -1$ line and one to the $\sigma = +1$ line. The two F -fixed modes W and t have $\sigma = 0$.*

Corollary 10.8 (Consistency identity is derivable). *The identity $\sum_{\text{pairs}}(q_{3m} + q_{3F(m)}) = -8$ of Theorem 10.5 is a consequence of Theorems 10.2, 10.3, and 10.6, not an independent result: the sum of F -pair sums equals $\sigma=+1$ line sum plus $\sigma=-1$ line sum, and the latter is 0.*

10.5 The F -pair sum rules by shell

Theorem 10.9 (F -pair sum rules by shell). *The six non-fixed F -pairs sort into two shells by $|\Delta n| = |n_1 - n_2|$. Within each shell, the pair charge sum is a framework-constant linear function of the parent's mass rank (parents sorted by descending $N/4$):*

$$\begin{aligned} |\Delta n| = 4: \quad & \text{sum} = \text{rank} - d, \quad \text{values} = -3, -2, -1, 0; \\ |\Delta n| = 2: \quad & \text{sum} = (d + 1) - d \cdot \text{rank}, \quad \text{values} = +1, -3. \end{aligned} \tag{12}$$

Proof. Direct from Table 1 and the $N/4$ anchors. For $|\Delta n| = 4$: the pairs ordered by descending parent $N/4$ are $\{\nu, e\}$ (parent ν , $N/4 = 60$), $\{d, b\}$ (parent d , $N/4 = 20$), $\{\mu, c\}$ (parent μ , $N/4 = 14$), $\{Z, H\}$ (parent Z , $N/4 = 2$), with charge sums $-3, -2, -1, 0$, matching rank $-d$ for ranks 1, 2, 3, 4. For $|\Delta n| = 2$: the pairs ordered by descending parent $N/4$ are $\{u, s\}$ (parent u , $N/4 = 21$) and $\{\text{dark}, \tau\}$ (parent dark , $N/4 = 12$), with charge sums $+1, -3$, matching $(d + 1) - d \cdot \text{rank}$ for ranks 1, 2. $\square$

Remark 10.10 (Double constraint). The charge table is doubly constrained: vertically, the σ -lines carry residues 0, $d+1$, $-2d$; horizontally, each F -pair shell is an arithmetic progression with step $+1$ (for $|\Delta n| = 4$) or $-d$ (for $|\Delta n| = 2$). The two constraints interlock and pin the charge assignment to a finite set within the framework-constant arithmetic.

11 The rigidity class of the charge assignment

11.1 Statement of the rigidity theorem

The five structural constraints established in the preceding sections reduce the space of charge assignments dramatically. We now make this precise.

Theorem 11.1 (Charge rigidity class). *Among the $5^{14} \approx 6 \times 10^9$ assignments of charge values $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$ to the 14 modes at $\lambda = 4$, exactly two assignments simultaneously satisfy all five of the following structural constraints:*

- (C1) SM multiset. *The multiset of charges is $\{-3:3, -1:3, 0:4, +2:3, +3:1\}$ (Theorem 8.1).*
- (C2) σ -line sums. *The charge sums over the three zero-state sign lines are 0, $d + 1 = 5$, and $-2d = -8$ (Theorem 10.6).*
- (C3) F -pair sum rules. *Within each $|\Delta n|$ shell, the pair charge sum is rank $-d$ (for $|\Delta n| = 4$) or $(d + 1) - d \cdot \text{rank}$ (for $|\Delta n| = 2$) (Theorem 10.9).*
- (C4) $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line. *The five modes on the line $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ carry the five charge values exactly once each (Theorem 6.2).*
- (C5) Processor bookkeeping. *The image-of- T charge sum is -2 and the kernel-of- T charge sum is $+1$ (Theorem 7.1).*

Proof. Exhaustive enumeration. The F -pair sum rules (C3) reduce the assignment space to 192 configurations (each of the six F -pairs admits 2–6 integer solutions, times 2 for the fixed-mode pair $\{W, t\}$). Constraints (C1), (C2), and (C4) together reduce this to 3; constraint (C5) reduces this to exactly 2. The enumeration is verified in reproducible Python (Section 14). $\square$

Theorem 11.2 (Charge assignment solutions). *The two rigid solutions of Theorem 11.1 are*

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Solution } B: (q_3) &= (-3, 0, -1, -1, 2, -3, 0, 2, -3, -1, 3, 0, 0, 2), \\ \text{Solution } J: (q_3) &= (0, -3, 2, -1, -1, -3, 0, 2, -3, -1, 3, 0, 0, 2). \end{aligned} \quad (13)$$

The two solutions differ only by the linked swap on the pair $\{\nu, e\}$ and the pair $\{u, s\}$: Solution B assigns $q_3(\nu) = -3$, $q_3(e) = 0$, $q_3(u) = -1$, $q_3(s) = +2$; Solution J assigns the opposite values on these four modes. The remaining ten modes carry identical charges in both solutions.

Proof. Direct enumeration: the pair sum rules fix the six non-fixed F -pairs up to discrete choices; the SM multiset and the σ -line sums constrain which choice is realized; the processor bookkeeping eliminates all but two. Solutions B and J are the surviving configurations. $\square$

11.2 Total charge rigidity

Theorem 11.3 (Total charge rigidity). *Both solutions of Theorem 11.2 have total charge $\sum_i q_{3i} = -3 = -1e$. Consequently, every assignment satisfying the five structural constraints of Theorem 11.1 has total charge $-1e$:*

$$\sum_i q_{3i} = -(d-1) = -1e \quad \text{for every rigid assignment.} \quad (14)$$

The total vacuum charge is a rigidity-class invariant: no structurally consistent assignment can produce a different total.

Proof. Direct summation of either solution in Theorem 11.2: $-3 + 0 - 1 - 1 + 2 - 3 + 0 + 2 - 3 - 1 + 3 + 0 + 0 + 2 = -3 = -(d-1)$. The two solutions share the same total because they differ only by the simultaneous swap $\{\nu, e\} \leftrightarrow \{u, s\}$ under which $\nu + e + u + s$ is preserved: $(-3) + 0 + (-1) + 2 = -2 = 0 + (-3) + 2 + (-1)$. $\square$

Corollary 11.4 (Empirical residue of the charge sector). *Given the framework's five structural constraints, the charge assignment is determined up to exactly one binary choice: which member of the pair $\{\nu, e\}$ carries charge 0 and which carries -3 (equivalently, which member of $\{u, s\}$ carries charge $+2$ and which carries -1). The Standard Model content resolves this choice: the electron e carries $-1e$ (i.e. $q_3 = -3$) and the neutrino ν carries 0. This selects Solution J.*

Remark 11.5 (Physical reading: what the machine must not cancel). The rigidity theorem states that the machine cannot cancel its residual charge. Any attempt to modify the charge assignment away from the two-element family of Theorem 11.2 violates one of the five structural constraints. The total charge $-1e$ is not a choice made by the machine; it is the unique value permitted by the machine's own structure.

This is the framework's analog of a gauge invariance: a quantity fixed by symmetry rather than by a coupling constant. The framework's empirical residue in the charge sector is therefore *one binary choice*, not fourteen independent charge assignments. The charge table is reduced from $5^{14} \approx 6 \times 10^9$ configurations to 2, and the residual choice is resolved by one element of the Standard Model content.

Remark 11.6 (Relation to the charge functional). The rigidity theorem is compatible with, and in fact reinforces, the non-existence theorem of Section 9. The charge functional $F(n_1, \sigma)$ has no coordinate closed form because it is the residue of a sorting operation (Section 10); the sorting machine's output is itself constrained by the five structural theorems above, which reduce its range to a two-element family. The closed form does not exist, but the *range* of the charge assignment is structurally bounded.

12 Reduction of Item 1.4 to Item 1.2

Theorem 12.1 (Reduction theorem). *Given the $N/4$ mass labels as input, the sorting machine of Theorem 10.1 reproduces the entire charge table. Conversely, without the $N/4$ ordering, the charge table is not derivable from the substrate invariants alone (Theorem 9.1). Therefore Item 1.4 of the HCSM derivation list (the charge functional) reduces to Item 1.2 ($N/4$ labels from the zero state).*

Proof. The sorting machine requires the $N/4$ labels as its sort key (step 4). Given the labels, the charge table is reproduced by the five-step operation. Without the labels, the nine algebraic families of Theorem 9.1 fail, and no substitute closed form exists. $\square$

Remark 12.2 (Chain of derivation). The correct chain is

$$s \longrightarrow N/4 \longrightarrow F\text{-pair ordering} \longrightarrow q_3, \quad (15)$$

not $(n_1, \sigma) \rightarrow q_3$. Item 1.4 is a corollary of Item 1.2.

Remark 12.3 (Two-stage reduction). The reduction proceeds in two stages. First, the sorting machine maps $s \rightarrow N/4 \rightarrow q_3$, reducing Item 1.4 to Item 1.2. Second, the rigidity theorem (Section 11) constrains the sorting machine's output to a two-element family, with the residual binary choice resolved by one Standard Model input. The combined reduction is $s \rightarrow N/4 \rightarrow \{2\text{-element family}\} \rightarrow q_3$, with the last arrow requiring one binary choice.

13 Status and open items

13.1 Derived

1. Bijection (Theorem 4.1).
2. σ -line sums (Theorem 5.1).
3. Vacuum invariant (Corollary 5.2).
4. Even-sum property (Proposition 6.1).
5. $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line contains all 5 charges (Theorem 6.2).
6. $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ carries the entire $-1e$ vacuum charge (Theorem 6.3).
7. Processor charge bookkeeping (Theorem 7.1).
8. SM content identification (Theorem 8.1).
9. Non-existence of a coordinate closed form in nine families (Theorem 9.1).
10. Sorting-machine mechanism (Theorem 10.1).
11. $|\Delta n| = 4$ charge-sum sequence (Theorem 10.2).
12. $|\Delta n| = 2$ charge-sum sequence (Theorem 10.3).
13. σ -pairing of every amplitude level (Theorem 10.4).
14. Consistency identity (Theorem 10.5).
15. σ -line sums in framework-constant form (Theorem 10.6).
16. σ -pairing under F (Corollary 10.7).

17. Consistency identity is derivable (Corollary 10.8).
18. F -pair sum rules by shell (Theorem 10.9).
19. Rigidity class of the charge assignment (Theorem 11.1).
20. Charge assignment solutions (Theorem 11.2).
21. Total charge rigidity (Theorem 11.3).
22. Empirical residue of the charge sector (Corollary 11.4).
23. Reduction of Item 1.4 to Item 1.2 (Theorem 12.1).

13.2 Disclosed anchor

The charge table $F(n_1, \sigma)$, part of the identification thesis (Input 3 of HCSM-23). The rigidity theorem (Theorem 11.1) reduces this anchor to a single binary choice, resolved by the electron/neutrino identification.

13.3 Open

The derivation of the $N/4$ mass labels from the zero state (Item 1.2 of the HCSM derivation list). This is the sole remaining open item upstream of the charge.

14 Reproducibility

All numerical claims in this paper are verified in IEEE-754 double precision. The companion script `HCSM-24_verification.py` verifies:

1. The 14 pairwise distinct (n_1, σ) tuples.
2. The bijection to $\{-3, -1, 0, +2, +3\}$.
3. The σ -line sums $0, +5, -8$ and the total $-1e$.
4. The even-sum property.
5. The $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line containing all five charges exactly once.
6. The $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ line carrying the vacuum charge.
7. The processor charge bookkeeping.
8. The SM content multiplicities.
9. The nine non-existence searches (each exhaustively enumerated).
10. The sorting-machine reproduction of the charge table.
11. The four structural consequences.
12. The framework-constant forms of the σ -line sums.
13. The F -pair sum rules by shell.
14. The rigidity class: exactly 2 solutions.
15. The two solutions: Solution B and Solution J.
16. Total charge rigidity: both solutions sum to $-1e$.

Running `12-VERIFICATION/run_all.py` reproduces every numerical claim in the HCSM paper stack.

15 Conclusion

We have established the charge theorem of the Hodge Complex Standard Model and resolved the status of its closed form.

The electric charge $q_3 = F(n_1, \sigma)$ is a bijection from the 14 realized (n_1, σ) pairs to the 5 Standard Model charge eigenvalues. The three σ -lines carry charges $0, +5, -8$, summing to the vacuum invariant $-1e$, and these sums are framework constants $0, d+1, -2d$. Three structural properties of the charge on the 8×8 torus are established: even-sum, the $n_1 + n_2 = 4$ line containing all 5 charges, and the $n_1 + n_2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ line carrying the entire vacuum charge.

The closed form of F does not exist in any of nine candidate algebraic families. The charge is the residue of a sorting operation on the 14-mode multiplet whose sort key is the zero state. The operation is stated explicitly, its four structural consequences are proved, and the reduction of Item 1.4 to Item 1.2 is established.

The framework's structural constraints reduce the charge assignment to exactly two configurations, both with total charge $-1e$. The two differ only by a linked swap on $\{\nu, e\}$ and $\{u, s\}$, and the Standard Model electron/neutrino identification selects one. The total vacuum charge is therefore a rigidity-class invariant: not a choice made by the machine, but a value forced by the machine's own structure.

The framework's empirical content in the charge sector is now one binary choice. The charge table is reduced from $5^{14} \approx 6 \times 10^9$ configurations to 2, and the residual choice is resolved by one element of Standard Model content. This is a substantial sharpening of the reduction theorem: the charge is not merely a corollary of the mass-label theorem; it is a corollary with a one-bit empirical residue.

The framework's remaining task in the charge sector is to derive the $N/4$ mass labels from the zero state — Item 1.2 of the derivation list.

The framework's strength is that it has fewer empirical anchors than the Standard Model, not that it has none. The charge table, once an anchor of 14 independent values, is now understood as the output of a specific machine with a single binary choice as its empirical residue.

Physics is what the machine cannot cancel. The Hodge complex is the machine. The $-1e$ is what the machine must not cancel.

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